FUTURES MATTER EDUCATION

Futures Matter - Northwood, 122 Emily Street, Highgate, Birmingham, B12 0XJ

Attendance Policy

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1.0 AIMS

Futures Matter - Northwood is committed to meeting its obligations on school attendance, including those in the DfE guidance Working together to improve school attendance. Our pupils have social, emotional and mental health needs and autism, and many have missed a lot of education and moved through several schools. For them, being in school regularly is how they build trust, routine, relationships and the skills they need for adulthood. We know that absence is almost always a sign of something else going on, so we respond with understanding and support first.

We aim to build a whole-school culture that values good attendance. We will:

- set high expectations for the attendance and punctuality of every pupil, and adapt our support to each pupil's needs
- promote good attendance and explain its benefits to pupils, parents and carers
- act early to address patterns of absence, and reduce persistent and severe absence
- make sure every pupil has access to the full-time education to which they are entitled
- build strong relationships with families, so that pupils have the support they need to attend
- work with the placing local authority, social workers, health services and other partners to remove barriers to attendance
- recognise and reward good and improved attendance
- keep every pupil safe, because attendance and safeguarding are closely linked

2.0 LEGISLATION AND GUIDANCE

This policy is based on the DfE statutory guidance Working together to improve school attendance and the DfE guidance School attendance: parental responsibility measures. It is also based on the following legislation, which sets out the legal powers and duties that govern school attendance:

- Part 6 of the Education Act 1996
- Part 7 of the Education and Inspections Act 2006
- The School Attendance (Pupil Registration) (England) Regulations 2024
- The Education (Penalty Notices) (England) Regulations 2007, as amended
- The Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014
- The Children Act 1989 (section 36, education supervision orders)
- The Equality Act 2010

It also refers to Keeping Children Safe in Education (KCSIE) 2026, Working Together to Safeguard Children, the DfE guidance Arranging education for children who cannot attend school because of health needs, and the DfE guidance on mental health issues affecting a pupil's attendance. The statutory guidance and the penalty notice framework are written mainly for state-funded schools, so where they refer to the local authority or a maintained school, we apply them in the way that fits an independent special school (see section 7.4).

3.0 ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

Improving attendance is everyone's job. The people below have particular responsibilities.

Who	Responsibilities
The Proprietor and the School Governance Board	Set high expectations of leaders, staff, pupils and parents or carers. Make sure leaders carry out their duties and comply with the law on attendance, including recording attendance accurately in the register and sharing the required information with the DfE and local authorities. Make sure the school works effectively with local partners to remove barriers to attendance. Make sure the school has high aspirations for all pupils but adapts its processes and support to each pupil's needs. Review and challenge attendance data every half term (it is a standing item at Board meetings), and help leaders focus on the pupils or groups who need it most. Make sure all staff are trained on attendance, and that staff with a specific attendance role have extra training, including in analysing attendance data. Hold the Head Teacher to account for implementing this policy. The Chair of the Board is the governor responsible for attendance, and reviews the data with the Head Teacher, giving support and challenge.
The Head Teacher	Is responsible for implementing this policy. Monitors attendance data across the school and reports it to the Board. Supports staff in monitoring the attendance of individual pupils, and monitors the impact of the strategies in use. Decides whether to grant a leave of absence and whether an absence is authorised. Works with the parents or carers of pupils with SEND to develop support for attendance, including where school transport is regularly missed or where the pupil faces barriers in school. Tells the placing local authority when a pupil with an education, health and care (EHC) plan has falling attendance, or where there are barriers linked to the pupil's needs. Communicates the school's high expectations to pupils and families. Shares information from the register with local authorities (see section 4.8).
The designated senior leader responsible for attendance (the senior attendance champion)	The Head Teacher, Benjamin Neasom, who can be contacted on 0121 835 1360 or at benjamin.neasom@futuresmattereducation.co.uk. Leads, champions and improves attendance, and sets a clear vision. Evaluates expectations and processes, and has a strong grasp of attendance data. Makes sure systems for tackling absence are followed by all staff. Builds close and productive relationships with parents or carers to talk about attendance. Works with pupils, parents or carers and agencies to write Attendance Support Plans and reintegration plans, and delivers targeted support to pupils and families.
The attendance officer	The Finance and Business Support Manager and the school office team. Take calls about absence and record the reason on the school's management information system. Carry out first day calling (section 4.6). Check each day on pupils who are dual registered or attending elsewhere. Analyse attendance and punctuality data, compare it with local and national figures, and give regular reports to staff and to the Head Teacher. Advise the Head Teacher when a case needs to go to the local authority.

Who	Responsibilities
Tutors and teachers	Take the register accurately for every session, using the correct codes, and pass it to the school office on the same day. Notice patterns and changes in a pupil's attendance, mood or engagement, and tell the Head Teacher. Welcome every pupil back warmly after an absence, and talk with pupils about their attendance in a supportive way. Use attendance reports to support conversations with pupils and families.
The Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)	Considers the safeguarding risks in every unexplained absence and every pattern of absence, and decides when to ask for a welfare check or make a referral. Tells children's social care the same day about any unauthorised or unexplained absence of a pupil known to them, and tells the Virtual School Head about a looked-after child. The Head Teacher is the DSL, and the Deputy DSLs are Carrie-Ann McGurk (Proprietor) and Simone Welch.
Parents and carers	Make sure their child attends every session on time. Call the school before 9:00 am on the first and every day of an absence, giving the reason and the expected date of return. Give the school more than one emergency contact number. Arrange medical and other appointments outside school hours where possible. Tell the school about any difficulty that is affecting attendance, and ask for help early. Work with the school on an Attendance Support Plan where one is needed. Where this policy refers to a parent, it means the adult the school and the local authority decide is the most appropriate to work with, including everyone with parental responsibility and everyone who has day-to-day care of the child.
Pupils	Attend every timetabled session on time, tell a trusted adult if something is making it hard to come to school, and help to plan their own support.

4.0 RECORDING ATTENDANCE

4.1 The Attendance Register

We keep an electronic attendance register, and place all pupils on it. We take the register at the start of the morning session and once during the afternoon session. Using the national codes in the School Attendance (Pupil Registration) (England) Regulations 2024, we record whether each pupil is:

- present
- attending a place other than school
- absent, and whether the absence is authorised or not
- absent because of an unavoidable cause

Any change to the register includes the original entry, the new entry, the reason for the change, the date, and the name and position of the person who made it. We keep every entry for 6 years after the date it was made. The codes are in Appendix 1.

4.2 The School Day and Registration Times

The school gates and doors open at 8:45 am. Pupils should arrive by 8:55 am at the latest, when staff greet them before tutorial. Our breakfast club is available to pupils who arrive early, and gives them a calm start to the day and the chance to talk to staff and friends.

The morning register is taken at 9:00 am and stays open until 9:30 am. The afternoon register is taken at 12:45 pm and stays open for the same length of time, 30 minutes. The school day ends at 3:15 pm for pupils. A pupil who arrives before the register closes is marked late (code L). A pupil who arrives after it closes is marked absent (code U), but we record the time of arrival.

4.3 Unplanned Absence

Parents or carers must tell the school the reason for an unplanned absence on the first day, before 9:00 am, and on every following day of absence, by calling the school office on 0121 835 1360 (or, if they cannot call, by emailing office@futuresmattereducation.co.uk). They should give the pupil's name, the reason and the day they expect them back.

We mark absence due to physical or mental illness as authorised, unless we have a genuine concern about whether the illness is real. Where we have a genuine doubt, we may ask for medical evidence such as a doctor's note, prescription or appointment card. We do not ask for evidence unnecessarily. Parents may offer a reason, but only the school can authorise an absence.

4.4 Planned Absence

A medical or dental appointment is authorised if the parent or carer tells the school in advance. Where possible, appointments should be made outside school hours. Where an appointment is during school hours and is local, the pupil should attend before or after it, and should be out of school for the shortest time possible.

A parent or carer who wants any other absence in term time must apply as early as possible, and where they can at least two weeks before, using the leave of absence request form from the school office. See section 5.1.

4.5 Lateness and Punctuality

Many of our pupils travel on transport arranged by their local authority. Where this is the case, pupils should be ready in plenty of time before the transport arrives. If transport is missed, it is the parent's or carer's responsibility to get the pupil to school, as we cannot arrange other transport. If transport is not provided as agreed, we will tell the placing local authority and record code Y1.

We look at lateness as well as absence. Where a pupil is often late, a member of staff talks to the pupil and their family to find out why, and we agree what might help, such as a change to the morning routine, a key worker meeting them at the door, or a conversation with the transport provider through the local authority.

4.6 Following Up Unexplained Absence

Where a pupil does not arrive and we have not heard from the family, we will:

1. Call the parent or carer by 10:00 am on the first day to find out the reason. If we cannot reach them, we try the pupil's other emergency contacts.

2. Tell the DSL if there is no contact. The DSL decides whether the pupil may be at risk and whether to ask the police for a welfare check, or to tell the pupil's social worker.
3. Call the family on every further day of absence without explanation, to make sure the pupil is safe and to understand what has gone wrong.
4. Arrange a home visit, led by the Head Teacher or a member of staff they choose, by the third day of absence, or sooner where there are specific concerns, we cannot contact the family, or the family is receiving external support. The visit is to find out whether the pupil is well, what help is needed, and how we can support everyone to get the pupil back to school as soon as possible. Staff doing home visits follow the school's lone working and risk assessment arrangements.
5. Work out whether the absence is authorised and enter the correct code as soon as the reason is known, and no later than 5 working days after the session.
6. Offer support to the pupil and family to improve attendance, and consider early help or other support from partners, making referrals as quickly as possible.

Where support is not appropriate, is not working or is not being taken up, we will talk to the placing local authority about the next step (see section 7.4).

4.7 Reporting to Parents

We regularly tell parents and carers about their child's attendance. We send an attendance summary to every family every half term. Wherever possible we personalise the message, and describe absence in days and in the experiences the pupil has missed, as well as in percentages. We also tell parents or carers straight away if a pupil is at risk of becoming, or is, persistently absent. We tell the pupil's social worker and the placing local authority as set out in sections 3 and 8.

4.8 Pupils Joining, Leaving and Missing

We tell the placing local authority and the home local authority when a pupil's name is added to or removed from the admission register outside the normal transition times. We remove a pupil's name only in the circumstances the regulations allow, and only after the steps set out in the regulations. If a pupil is absent without authorisation for 10 school days in a row, or we do not know where a pupil is, we tell the local authority and take all reasonable steps to find the pupil, as a child missing from education. We also give the local authority the details of any pupil who is not attending regularly, and of any pupil we believe will miss 15 school days in a row or in total because of sickness.

When a pupil joins us, we ask the previous school and the local authority for their attendance history, so that we understand what support has been tried and what has helped.

5.0 AUTHORISED AND UNAUTHORISED ABSENCE

5.1 Leave of Absence in Term Time

The Head Teacher grants a leave of absence in term time only if the request fits the circumstances set out in the 2024 regulations. These are:

- taking part in a regulated performance, or regulated employment abroad
- attending an interview for employment or for admission to another school or college
- study leave
- a temporary, time-limited part-time timetable (see section 5.5)

- exceptional circumstances

We think of exceptional circumstances as rare and unexpected events that are unlikely to happen again, such as a medical emergency or a family emergency (for example the death of a relative). Leave is granted at the Head Teacher's discretion, including how long the pupil may be away. We look at each request individually, taking into account the facts, circumstances and background of the request, and we may ask for evidence. Because a leave of absence is granted only in exceptional circumstances, it is unlikely to be granted for a family holiday. We do not grant leave for a pupil to take part in protest activity during school hours.

5.2 Other Authorised Absence

Other reasons for authorised absence include:

- illness, including mental health illness, and medical or dental appointments (sections 4.3 and 4.4)
- religious observance, where the day is set apart for religious observance by the religious body to which the pupil's parent belongs. We may ask the religious body to confirm this, and pupils should attend on the days around it
- a parent travelling for work, where the pupil travels with them as a mobile child
- a suspension or permanent exclusion where no alternative provision has been made (code E)

5.3 Attending a Place Other Than School

A pupil who is away from the site but is attending an approved educational activity is not counted as absent. This includes an off-site activity, sports activity, visit or trip arranged by the school, work experience, education arranged by the local authority, and attending another school where the pupil is also registered (dual registration). It also covers an unavoidable cause such as widespread travel disruption, a lack of transport arranged by the local authority, or closure of the premises.

5.4 Unauthorised Absence

An absence is unauthorised where the law does not treat the reason as reasonable and the Head Teacher has not given leave. Examples are an absence with no explanation, an unauthorised holiday, and absence for reasons such as shopping, a day trip, a birthday, a hair appointment or oversleeping. We look at the reason behind every absence before we decide whether it is authorised. Where the reason is a difficulty linked to a pupil's SEND or mental health, we do not treat it as a matter of discipline, and we work with the family to remove the barrier.

5.5 Part-Time Timetables

Every pupil of compulsory school age is entitled to a full-time education. We do not use a part-time timetable as a response to behaviour, or as a long-term arrangement. In very exceptional circumstances, where it is in the pupil's best interests, we may agree a temporary, time-limited part-time timetable, for example as part of a short reintegration plan for a pupil whose anxiety or medical condition stops them attending full time. This is only done with the agreement of the pupil and their parents or carers, and the placing local authority, because the pupil's EHC plan sets out their provision. We record it with code C2, set an end date and review it at least every week with the pupil and their family. The pupil returns to full-time attendance as soon as they can.

6.0 PROMOTING GOOD ATTENDANCE

We want to reward good attendance, not only act when it is poor. We use a range of strategies to encourage good attendance and punctuality.

- **Weekly:** every pupil with 100% attendance for the week receives a certificate and merit points. We celebrate achievements privately with the pupil, and in tutorial, in assembly or on noticeboards as the pupil prefers.
- **Every half term:** certificates and prizes for pupils who have greatly improved their attendance, or who have 100% attendance since September.
- **Every year:** at the end of the summer term we recognise pupils with 100% attendance over the year, and over two or more years in a row.
- **Groups:** the Student Council is asked to consider awarding group points and certificates to the tutor groups with the highest attendance.
- **Individual rewards:** a pupil with an Attendance Support Plan may have their own reward linked to their targets.

Pupils can use merit points to buy small items from the school shop, such as stationery and books, or to save towards a larger reward, such as a reward trip or opportunity. This teaches the habits of the working world: attendance, punctuality, and earning, saving and spending. We do not pay pupils to come to school, and points are never exchanged for money, vouchers or food.

We know that many absences are not within a pupil's control, for example because of illness or a disability. So we also recognise improvement, we do not make a pupil feel punished for a genuine absence, and we make sure that no pupil is left out of celebration of their other achievements.

We tell parents and carers about our expectations and procedures at the admission meeting, where we share all relevant policies, and we send this policy to every family when their child joins. We remind families of the policy at the start of each school year and when it changes. We encourage open and honest conversation about attendance, because it helps us all find solutions.

7.0 SUPPORTING PUPILS WITH POOR ATTENDANCE

We use the full range of support, and where needed legal measures, to tackle poor attendance, and we decide each case individually. Support always comes first.

7.1 Early Help and the Attendance Support Plan

We review attendance each day and watch for patterns or trends in lateness and absence. Where a pupil needs extra support, the Head Teacher or another member of staff meets the pupil and their family to listen and understand the barriers, and explains the help that is available. We then write an Attendance Support Plan with them (Appendix 2). The plan sets out the roles of the pupil, the family and the school, with targets, timescales and any other services involved, and we review it regularly. For a pupil with an EHC plan, the Attendance Support Plan is part of their Individual Support Plan and links to their Positive Behaviour Support Plan.

7.2 Persistent and Severe Absence

A pupil is persistently absent when they miss 10% or more of school, which is about 19 days in a school year of 190 days. A pupil is severely absent when they miss 50% or more of school. Reducing persistent and severe absence is central to our strategy. In these cases we will:

- use attendance data to find patterns and trends, and consider whether there may be a safeguarding concern, following KCSIE
- hold regular meetings with the parents or carers of pupils who are vulnerable, at risk of persistent or severe absence, or already persistently or severely absent, to talk about attendance and engagement, listen to the barriers, explain the help that is available, explain the possible consequences and sanctions, and review actions already in place
- give access to wider support services to remove barriers to attendance, working with the placing local authority where relevant
- consider other support that could help the pupil re-engage, bearing in mind the sensitivity of some of the reasons for absence
- keep one consistent person working with the family wherever we can
- use legal measures only where support is not appropriate, has not worked or has not been taken up (section 7.4)

7.3 What Attendance Means in Days

Small amounts of absence add up. This table shows what attendance means over a school year of 190 days.

Attendance	What it means
97% or above	5 days or fewer missed. Strong attendance.
96%	About 8 days missed, which is more than 1 week of school.
95%	About 10 days missed, which is 2 weeks of school.
90%	About 19 days missed, nearly 4 weeks. This is persistent absence.
85%	About 28 days missed, nearly 6 weeks. This is persistent absence and a serious concern for progress.
50% or below	About 95 days missed, half of the year. This is severe absence.

7.4 Legal Measures

Legal measures are a last resort. We use them only where support is not appropriate (for example an unauthorised holiday), has not worked, or has not been taken up, and always after we have thought about the pupil's needs and our duties under the Equality Act 2010. Many of our pupils have SEMH needs, autism or other disabilities, and the barriers they face are rarely addressed by a fine.

Education supervision order. Where voluntary support has not worked, we may work with the local authority, which can apply for an education supervision order. The authority writes to the parent and sets up a meeting. An order is a formal intervention, not a prosecution. It

lasts for 1 year and may be extended for up to 3 years at a time. A parent who persistently fails to follow the directions may be fined up to £1,000 on conviction.

Notice to improve. Where the national threshold is met, support is appropriate, but parents do not take it up, a notice to improve gives them a final chance. It is issued under the local code of conduct of the local authority, and sets out the pupil's attendance record, the support given so far, the benefits of regular attendance, a warning that a penalty notice or prosecution may follow, what sufficient improvement looks like, and an improvement period of 3 to 6 weeks.

Penalty notices. A penalty notice is a fine for unauthorised absence of a pupil of compulsory school age. The national threshold is 10 sessions of unauthorised absence in a rolling 10 school week period. If it is paid, the first notice is £80 within 21 days or £160 within 28 days. A second notice for the same pupil to the same parent is £160 within 28 days. A third notice cannot be issued to the same parent for the same child within 3 years of the first, and other action is taken instead. Payment is made to the local authority, which decides whether to prosecute if it is not paid after 28 days.

We do not issue penalty notices ourselves. If we believe the threshold is met and a penalty notice might be appropriate, we talk to the pupil's local authority, which decides whether to issue one. We will not ask for a penalty notice where it would be inappropriate because of our duties under the Equality Act 2010, or where further support or another measure would be better. We tell the placing local authority before any legal measure is taken in respect of a pupil with an EHC plan.

8.0 SUPPORTING PUPILS WITH BARRIERS TO ATTENDANCE

8.1 Pupils with SEND

Every pupil at our school has an EHC plan. Their right to an education is the same as any other pupil's, and our ambition for their attendance is the same. They may need more support to meet it. We work with parents and carers to find out what stops a pupil attending, and we put in place support such as:

- sensitive conversations about the pupil's needs, and reasonable adjustments where the pupil has a disability
- removing barriers in school, such as the pupil's routine, key adult, sensory environment, access to a calm space, uniform, lunchtime arrangements and transport
- support from the pupil's Positive Behaviour Support Plan and Individual Support Plan
- referrals, made in good time, to partners such as the local authority, educational psychologists, CAMHS or health services, and working with them on the support they offer
- joined-up pastoral care, with a key worker who knows the pupil well

Where a pupil's attendance falls, or the barriers are related to their needs, we tell the placing local authority and ask for an early review of the EHC plan where the provision is not enabling the pupil to attend. See our SEND Policy.

8.2 Pupils with Anxiety About Attending School

Many of our pupils find attending school hard because of anxiety, sensory overload, past experiences or fear of failure. This is sometimes called emotionally based school avoidance.

We treat this as a need for support, not as defiance. We listen to the pupil and their family and try to understand what is happening, plan small steps with the pupil, agree a trusted adult, and make sure staff respond in a consistent, calm and kind way. A time-limited reintegration plan may be agreed (section 5.5). We involve CAMHS or other professionals where it would help.

8.3 Pupils Absent Because of Ill Health

Parents and carers should use the NHS guidance Is my child too ill for school? when they decide whether to keep their child at home, and we will share it with them and help them understand it. For a pupil with a long-term medical or mental health need, we work with the family and health professionals to put an individual healthcare plan in place where needed, make reasonable adjustments, and give the support the pupil needs to attend as much as they can. When a pupil is away and well enough, we will send work, and consider remote education. Where we expect a pupil to miss 15 school days or more through sickness, we tell the local authority, which has a duty to arrange suitable education for a pupil who cannot attend school because of health needs. See our Supporting Pupils with Medical Conditions Policy.

8.4 Looked-After Children and Pupils with a Social Worker

We pay particular attention to the attendance of looked-after children and pupils who have or have had a social worker. We tell the pupil's social worker, and the Virtual School Head for a looked-after child, on the same day about any unexplained or unauthorised absence, and we share attendance data with them regularly. We check attendance for these pupils every day.

8.5 Returning to School After an Absence

We want every pupil to feel welcome when they return, whatever the reason for the absence. After a lengthy or unavoidable period of absence, the Head Teacher or the pupil's key worker meets the pupil and their family, if possible before the return, to plan how we will support them. The plan may include a gradual return, catch-up work, a quiet space, and a named adult. After a suspension, we follow the reintegration meeting process in our Suspension and Exclusion Policy.

9.0 MONITORING ATTENDANCE

We monitor attendance and punctuality data every week, half term, term and year, across the school and for each pupil, tutor group and group of pupils. We compare our data with local, regional and national figures to find where to focus. Specific pupil information is shared with the DfE on request. Termly, DfE publishes national and local authority absence statistics.

We analyse the data to find the pupils, groups and patterns that need extra support. We look at historic and emerging patterns, days and times when attendance is poor, and patterns of use of the different codes, and we use the findings to develop targeted action. We look at the impact of what we do, and change it where it is not working. We share information and work with other schools, local authorities and partners where a pupil's absence is at risk of becoming persistent or severe.

Who and when	What happens
Every day: school office	Takes the calls, records the reason for absence, calls families by 10:00 am where we have not heard, and checks pupils who are dual registered or attending elsewhere. Gives the Head Teacher a list of the day's absences and reasons.
Every day: Head Teacher	Decides whether each absence is authorised and what action is needed, and arranges home visits.
Every day: DSL	Tells social care about any unauthorised or unexplained absence of a pupil known to them, and checks looked-after children.
Every week: Fridays	School office identifies pupils with 100% attendance, prepares certificates and merit points, and updates the noticeboards. The Head Teacher celebrates attendance in tutorial or assembly.
Every week: Mondays	The designated senior leader reviews headline attendance for tutor groups and the whole school, looked-after children, persistent absentees and pupils with an Attendance Support Plan.
Every half term	School office sends an attendance summary to the parents or carers of every pupil. The Head Teacher reports trends, concerns and actions to the Proprietor and the Board, and the Chair of the Board reviews the data and provides support and challenge.
Every term	Analysis of attendance, persistent and severe absence, and punctuality by group, including pupils with SEND, looked-after children and other groups, with a comparison to national figures.
Before admission	School office gathers attendance data from the pupil's previous schools.

Data is available to the placing local authorities, the DfE and Ofsted, or any other inspectorate, as appropriate.

10.0 MONITORING ARRANGEMENTS

This policy is reviewed every year by the Head Teacher, and sooner if DfE or local authority guidance changes. It is approved by the Proprietor and the School Governance Board. At each review we ask for the views of pupils and parents or carers. We publish the policy on our website, and we remind parents or carers about it at the start of each school year and whenever it changes.

11.0 LINKS WITH OTHER POLICIES

- Safeguarding and Child Protection Policy
- Behaviour, Rewards and Sanctions Policy
- SEND Policy
- Supporting Pupils with Medical Conditions Policy
- Suspension and Exclusion Policy
- Admissions Policy

- Complaints Policy

References: Working together to improve school attendance, DfE; School attendance: parental responsibility measures, DfE; The School Attendance (Pupil Registration) (England) Regulations 2024; Keeping Children Safe in Education 2026; Working Together to Safeguard Children, DfE; Arranging education for children who cannot attend school because of health needs, DfE; Is my child too ill for school?, NHS; Model policy: attendance (schools), The Key (July 2026).

12.0 APPENDICES

Appendix 1: Attendance Codes

Appendix 2: Attendance Support Plan

APPENDIX 1: ATTENDANCE CODES

These are the national attendance codes from the DfE guidance. The school uses these codes in the register.

Code	What it means
PRESENT	Group of codes
/	Present in the morning
****	Present in the afternoon
L	Late arrival, before the register has closed
ATTENDING A PLACE OTHER THAN SCHOOL	Group of codes
K	Attending education provision arranged by the local authority
V	Attending an educational visit or trip organised or approved by the school
P	Taking part in a supervised sporting activity approved by the school
W	Attending an approved work experience placement
B	Attending any other approved educational activity
D	Dual registered: attending a session at another setting where the pupil is also registered
ABSENT: LEAVE OF ABSENCE	Group of codes
C1	Taking part in a regulated performance or regulated employment abroad
M	Medical or dental appointment
J1	Interview with an employer or educational establishment
S	Study leave to study for a public examination
X	Not required to be in school (pupil not of compulsory school age)
C2	Part-time timetable
C	Leave of absence for exceptional circumstances
ABSENT: OTHER AUTHORISED REASONS	Group of codes
T	Parent travelling for occupational purposes (mobile child)

Code	What it means
R	Religious observance
I	Illness, either physical or mental, other than a medical or dental appointment
E	Suspended or excluded, with no alternative provision made
ABSENT: UNABLE TO ATTEND BECAUSE OF AN UNAVOIDABLE CAUSE	Group of codes
Q	Lack of access arrangements: the local authority has not made the arrangements needed for the pupil to attend
Y1	Transport not available, where the school is not within walking distance and the transport normally provided is not available
Y2	Widespread disruption to travel caused by a local, national or international emergency
Y3	Part of the school premises is closed and the pupil cannot be accommodated in the part that is open
Y4	The whole school site is unexpectedly closed, for example because of adverse weather
Y5	Criminal justice detention: in police detention, remanded to youth detention or detained under a sentence of detention
Y6	Travel to or attendance at school is prohibited under public health guidance or law
Y7	Any other unavoidable cause not covered by the other codes
ABSENT: UNAUTHORISED	Group of codes
G	Holiday not granted by the school
N	Reason for absence not yet established, before the register closes
O	Absent in other or unknown circumstances, or the school is not satisfied that the reason given is acceptable
U	Arrived in school after registration closed, but before the end of the session
ADMINISTRATIVE CODES	Group of codes
Z	Prospective pupil not on the admission register
#	Planned whole-school closure, including school holidays

APPENDIX 2: ATTENDANCE SUPPORT PLAN

Complete this plan with the pupil and their parents or carers. Review it regularly, share a copy with the family, and keep it on the pupil's file. For a pupil with an EHC plan, link it to their Individual Support Plan.

ATTENDANCE SUPPORT PLAN - to be completed with the pupil and family	
Pupil's name, year group and date the plan was written:	
Attendance so far this academic year (days and percentage), and any pattern (days, times, lessons):	
Attendance last academic year, and the reasons for absence, support given and its impact:	
Attendance at previous schools, the reasons for absence and what was tried:	
The pupil's views: what makes it hard to come to school, and what would help:	
The views of the parents or carers (and names of the people who gave information):	
Barriers identified (SEND, health, anxiety, transport, family, in-school):	
Actions to improve attendance: what will be done, who will do it, and by when:	
Support from other agencies or services, and who will refer:	
Reward or recognition agreed with the pupil:	
Is a time-limited reintegration plan or part-time timetable needed? Reason, end date and weekly review:	
Review dates and the impact of each action:	
Signed and dated: pupil, parent or carer, and senior leader:	